PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
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Date: February 18, 2025
To: School Board
From: Dr. Franco, Chief of Schools
Subject: 2025-26 School District Calendar

Staff is submitting this recommended 2025-26 School District Calendar for the Board to consider and vote on at the February 18, 2025 Board meeting. This draft was first shared with the Board for feedback at the February 4th Board meeting.

The proposed calendar includes the following agreements that align with the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) Collective Bargaining Agreement :

- 193 contract days
- 176 Instructional days, which include 3 conference days
- Eight early release days for PK, K-5, K8, K12, and middle schools for staff learning
- 10, 60 minute staff learning times for PK, K5, K8, K12 and middle schools throughout the year
- 30, 90-minute staff learning/meetings for high schools throughout the year.

For the 2025-26 school year, two CSI/TSI days have been added to support the ODE-designated schools and provide them with the opportunity for professional development and learning. These are currently listed as August 19, 2025, and March 2, 2026. These additional professional development days are contingent on budget decisions and are placeholders for the time being. Should funds be allocated during the budget process, professional educators from schools identified for improvement (CSI and TSI schools) would be required to attend. These are additional days added to the calendar and do not reduce the existing instructional days.

Feedback was received from building administrators, the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT), the Portland Federation of School Professionals (PFSP), Racial Equity and Social Justice Partners (RESJ), and community members which has been incorporated into the proposed 2025-2026 Calendar.

The recommended calendar for the 2025-26 school year includes the following:

- Maintains the start of the school year before Labor Day
- Attempts to preserve or maximize uninterrupted whole weeks for instruction; no scheduled classes are proposed during Thanksgiving week to support family childcare planning and permit academic-teacher conferences to take place
- Aims to balance instructional days by quarter and semester: Q1 = 45 days, Q2 = 43 (this does not include conference days), Q3 = 40 days and Q4 = 45 days
- Aligns with the requirements in the various bargaining units' contracts
- Coordinates spring break with local university calendars, to align with schedules of older siblings and university student interns who work in our classrooms; Oregon spring break is traditionally the last full 5-day work week in March

- Ensures instructional hours for all students meet state requirements
- Attempts to maximize instructional days before Advanced Placement, International Baccalaureate, and other end-of-year summative assessments take place
- Avoids conflicts with major religious and cultural holidays to the extent possible
    - District practice has been to communicate to building administrators in multiple ways to avoid scheduling special school events on dates of major religious and cultural holidays
- The continued practice of a 4-day “Kindergarten Ramp Up” where all Kindergarten students will have one day in school over the four days with smaller numbers of students to orient them to school. Historically, Kindergarten has started 3 days after grades 1-12. The three days were mostly used for 1:1 assessments with students. Adding a day will provide all students with a smaller group 1-day orientation, relationship building, and 1:1 family connections. This practice day counts as one day of instruction.
- To align with the PK agreement with PAT, PK will start on September 4, 2025, this will meet with the provision of designating 10 days before the first instructional day: 2.5 PD days, 1.5 set up/planning days, and 6 No Child Days (for home visits, etc).
- A 1-day Ramp Up for 6th, 9th, and 12th graders at comprehensive middle and high schools to support the transition for students to a new building for 6th and 9th graders and to kick off the final year for seniors

Additional feedback was received from families, administrators, teachers, and PPS staff, primarily through the Let’s Talk program.

- Many parents expressed concerns about the number of days off and early release days in the proposed 2025-2026 school calendar.
- Several parents suggested that professional development days and early release days be moved to Mondays or Fridays, as this would be easier for working parents to manage childcare.
- Some parents proposed starting the school year after Labor Day due to hot classrooms in August.
- Other feedback included requests for fewer half days and more full days off, adding certain holidays to the calendar, and keeping the regular start times for elementary schools.
- One person expressed that a teacher's work day after winter break is essential.

Staff recommends adopting this proposed calendar now so that staff and families may plan for the upcoming year.